# Editorial Summary - MS1 · P13 Padel Predictor

14.10.2026 · Reviews received: A, B

## What the reviewers and we see

The project predicts, every morning, the probability that pair A beats pair B for upcoming Premier Padel and FIP main-draw matches, and scores only the last pre-match prediction against the data provider's own Elo. Both reviewers and we find the framing, the leakage controls (state updated after the feature row, winner-flip unit test, hash-based A/B assignment) and the FTI design convincing. The central open issue is timing: the baseline number and the weekly ranking snapshots must both be strictly pre-match, or the comparison and the features are not what they claim to be.

## Points to act on

Answer every point below in `docs/ms2_summary.pdf`, one numbered entry per point with a status (Changed / Partly / Rejected / Not yet) and a commit or file. Use these labels.

**Must**

- **A2 · Baseline is not measured on your test set**: The 71.8 % / 0.517 log loss is the provider's claim on 7,500 of its own matches, and it is unknown whether it uses pre-match ratings. Confirmed and decisive: recompute the provider-Elo log loss yourself, on exactly your out-of-time test matches, using the ranking-history snapshot strictly before each match. Only that number is the bar for the success criterion and for promoting a challenger over the Elo champion.
- **E1 · Weekly snapshots can leak same-week results**: Rankings and provider Elo are joined "as-of the match date", but the snapshots are weekly and tournaments run Wednesday to Sunday. A snapshot dated inside a tournament week can already contain the earlier rounds, and possibly the result, of the match being predicted. Join on the snapshot's publication timestamp, require it to be strictly before `scheduled_at`, and add this case to your leakage unit tests. The same rule applies to the baseline in A2.

**Should**

- **A1 · No minimum margin on ~2,000 test matches**: "Lower log loss than the baseline" can be met by noise on a test set of this size. State a minimum margin or report a bootstrap confidence interval on the log-loss difference, so a win over the Elo baseline means something.
- **E2 · Paid data tier: real volume and a fallback**: The volume (~10,000 matches since 2023) is an estimate, and the full archive and ranking history need your paid subscription. In the MS2 summary, report the actual counts per tier and season, and document a free-tier fallback (last six months) so reviewers can run the feature pipeline.
- **B1 · Define how player values become team features**: Padel is played in pairs, but the proposal only says "recent win rate per player". Specify how form_diff, rest_days_diff and partnership are aggregated from the two players (mean, min, pair history) and how a new partnership without history is handled, before the feature schema is fixed in MS2.

**Could**

- **E3 · Report what partnership and rest add**: With ~10,000 balanced matches, keep the feature set small until ablations justify more, and report the contribution of partnership, form and rest against the Elo baseline explicitly: that is your thesis.

- **E4 · Log which model served which day**: Keep the champion/challenger rule simple and record the serving model per prediction, since monitoring scores only the last pre-match prediction.

## Looking ahead to MS2

MS2 is the feature pipeline: we expect the as-of join at snapshot timestamp (E1) in code with a test, the real archive counts, and the recomputed Elo baseline on your split, so that MS3 starts from a fair bar.

## Feedback on the reviews you wrote

Two substantive reviews with specific, verified concerns. Strongest: your P12 analysis that baseline and model share the same momentum signal, with an ablation in MLflow as a concrete test, and the 5–10 min snapshot-age gap. Your P05 review raises useful scheduling and regional-holiday points but misses the label definition after the switch to 15-minute day-ahead products, and slightly overstates the timing risk.